Managing the template library

The template library

The templates used by *Template Central* are stored in a SharePoint document library. It is recommended that a single, central, library is used for all templates. However, it is possible to use different libraries for different areas of your system if required.

Inheriting metadata

Any metadata that is set on the document templates in the *template library* will be inherited by documents created using that template where:

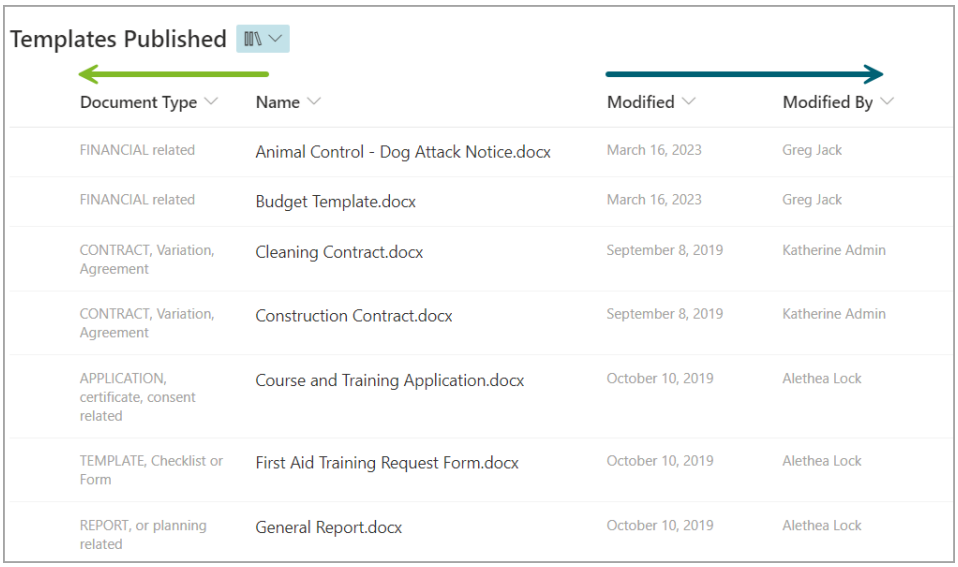
- The internal and display names of the column in the *template library* are the same as those in the *destination library.*
- The column type is text or choice. Inheritance of calculated columns is not currently supported.
- The column type is choice and the value in the template exists in the *destination library*. All choice columns must be set to allow fill in choices. Thus, preventing the scenario where the template has a value that is not in the list of available choices in the *destination library.*

This is a useful mechanism for reducing the amount of user-defined metadata required for new documents. Therefore, thought needs to be given to the design.

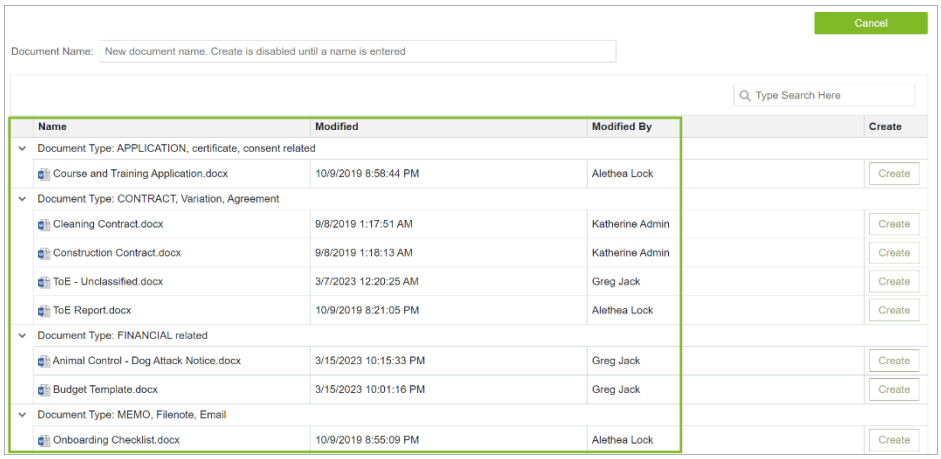
Views

The views in the *Template library* are important because they control how the templates are displayed to users. You can configure different views of the templates to display in different document libraries (e.g.to display only HR related templates in HR related document libraries you could create a HR view).

The tree view grouping is controlled by the order of columns in a view; SharePoint is normally limited to 2 levels of grouping but *Template Central* has no limit. Any column before the *Name* column will be used to group the templates (e.g. Document Type in the example below). Any columns after the *Name* column are displayed to users as text (e.g. Modified and Modified By in the example below).



The view above is displayed to the user as:



Additional considerations

All views in the *Template library* must include the *Name* column as this is used to control the tree view grouping.

Changes to the filters, columns displayed, and the order of columns are fine, but care should be taken with other settings. For example, SharePoint grouping is ignored and has no effect, whilst other options may prevent *Template Central* from functioning properly.